

Spring Into QC

Operational Plan

Frontier Family Park, Queen Creek, AZ | Annual March Event, 9:00 AM – 1:00 PM | 3,500+ Attendees

1. Executive Summary

Event: Spring Into QC, Town of Queen Creek's annual free, family-oriented spring community event

Venue: Frontier Family Park, 20039 S. 220th Street, Queen Creek, AZ

Date / Window: Annual March date; 9:00 AM–1:00 PM public window (operational day extends roughly 5:00 AM–6:00 PM for build and teardown)

Projected Scale: 3,500+ attendees. Plan capacity and staffing to a **4,000-person working ceiling**.

Core Objectives

- Deliver a safe, single-day event across a multi-zone, fixed-field park footprint
- Sustain attendee engagement across the full 4-hour window, not just through the egg hunt
- Operate with existing Town staff and vendor relationships redeployed, not a new headcount base
- Meet all municipal permitting, safety, and inter-departmental coordination requirements for a 3,500+ person public gathering

2. Site Operations & Logistics

Zone Map

Zone	Function	Notes
Zone A: Egg Hunt Fields	Age-staggered egg hunts, 9:30 AM–12:30 PM	Roped outfield(s), spectator line along fencing; highest single-point crowd density of the event
Zone B: Animal Race Arena	Fenced arena, hay-bale seating	5 heats from 10:00 AM; controlled ingress/egress points
Zone C: Play Pods	Tot Spot, Play Zone, Color Blast	Grouped on turf near splash pad; good for absorbing overflow crowd
Zone D: The Spine (Vendor Row)	Vendor booths, sponsor activations, photo/QR pickup	Central paved walkway connecting all zones, the single load-bearing artery for pedestrian flow and vendor resupply
Zone E: Family Amenity Zone	Inclusive playground, splash pad, picnic ramadas	Unstructured; useful pressure-release valve during peak Zone A congestion
Zone F: Parking & Ingress	Public lot(s), ADA parking, stroller/wagon drop zone	Use park's existing lot capacity first; identify one overflow lot before committing to a shuttle

Zone	Function	Notes
Zone G: Command Post / First Aid / Lost & Found	Centralized near main entrance	Co-locate EMS, security check-in, and lost-child reunification in one visible, signed location

Parking & Traffic Control

- Confirm on-site lot capacity against the 4,000-person working ceiling; trigger overflow lot + shuttle plan only if on-site capacity falls short
- Coordinate ingress/egress lane control on S. 220th Street with Queen Creek PD
- Dedicated ADA parking adjacent to Zone G; dedicated stroller/wagon drop-off separate from vehicle traffic

Waste Management

- Waste/recycling pairs stationed at every zone exit, doubling as a natural checkpoint for the Zone A → Spine handoff signage already planned for crowd flow
- Roll-off dumpster scheduled with Public Works for post-event bulk pickup; recycling stream separated given food vendor volume
- Post-event park sweep scheduled same day before park reopens to general public use

3. Safety & Risk Management

Emergency Medical Services

- Staffed first-aid station at Zone G, visibly signed from all zones

Security Deployment

- Off-duty Queen Creek PD officers posted at Zone F ingress/egress and Zone G
- **Lost-child protocol:** wristband station at Zone F entry (child's name + guardian phone), a standing reunification point at Zone G, and a defined radio code for staff to call a lost-child alert without a public PA announcement that could cause alarm

Weather Contingencies

- March in Queen Creek is generally mild (65–80°F), so this is a sun/wind plan, not a heat-emergency plan, but should not be skipped
- Shade structures and water stations at every zone, not just Zone A
- Wind/dust monitoring via NWS alerts; trigger point defined for securing tents/signage
- Lightning/severe weather shelter-in-place location identified in advance, with a defined suspend/resume protocol
- Rain plan defined in advance: proceed rain-or-shine, delay, or reschedule, and who has authority to make that call day-of

Site-Specific Risk Items

- **5-acre fishing lake proximity:** confirm event footprint's distance from the lake; post no-swimming signage and brief staff on the boundary if any zone borders it

- **Live animals (Fast & Furriest Races):** handwashing/sanitizer station at Zone B exit; confirm vendor's own animal-handling and containment protocol as part of contracting
- **Inflatables (Play Zone/Tot Spot):** certified operator and daily safety inspection sign-off required before gates open, documented for liability
- **Zone A exit congestion:** the highest-risk crowd-flow point in the event; staffed handoff at this exit is a safety measure as much as an engagement one. Brief security/EMS on this as a watch zone

4. Vendor & Entertainment Management

Staging & Layout

- Vendor booths (10'×10', existing fee structure \$75–\$125) staged along Zone D, spaced rather than clustered, to sustain foot traffic the full length of the spine
- Entertainment/PA and emcee station positioned centrally on the spine, audible into Zones A and B without requiring a second sound system

Power & Water

- Shore power drops or generators spaced along Zone D at intervals matched to booth type. Food vendors require dedicated higher-amperage drops; craft/info vendors do not
- Water access point(s) for food vendors coordinated with Public Works; confirm backflow/health requirements
- Any generator or open-flame food prep (funnel cake, grills) requires Fire Marshal sign-off. Flag at the T-3-month permitting stage, not day-of

Load-In / Load-Out

- Defined vendor unloading lane, separate from public parking and pedestrian ingress, active 6:00–8:00 AM
- Load-out window opens at event close (1:00 PM) and is staggered by zone (Zone D first, Zone A/B after crowd clears) to avoid vendor vehicles crossing active foot traffic

Permitting Checklist

- Temporary use / special event permit (Parks & Rec)
- Health department permit: required per food vendor
- Fire Marshal inspection: tents over 400 sq ft, any generator or open flame
- Noise/sound permit check against municipal ordinance for the PA/emcee system

5. Staffing & Volunteer Deployment

Command Structure (ICS-aligned, scaled to event size)

- **Event Director** (Incident Commander): overall authority, single point of decision for weather suspension, safety escalation
- **Operations Lead:** owns the 7 zones day-of; each zone has a Zone Captain (existing staff, redeployed) reporting up
- **Logistics Lead:** parking, waste, rentals (tents/fencing/restrooms), vendor load-in/out
- **Safety Officer:** single liaison to EMS/PD, owns the lost-child and weather-suspension protocols

- **PIO / Communications Lead:** owns PA announcements, social media, and the vendor/attendee-facing information table

Volunteer Roles

- Zone greeters / handoff staff (Zone A exit prioritized: highest volume, most time-critical)
- Vendor coordinator (roving, resolves booth-level issues without pulling in the Logistics Lead)
- Registration/check-in table (wristbands, raffle entry, photo/QR gallery instructions)
- Roving "Ambassadors" in Town-branded shirts, general wayfinding, freeing Zone Captains from routine questions

Staffing Ratios

- General zone coverage: ~1 staff/volunteer per 150–200 attendees
- Elevated coverage at Zone A exit and Zone G given disproportionate foot traffic and risk concentration

Communications

- Two-way radios on three defined channels: Command, Operations, Safety/EMS, preventing routine zone chatter from blocking a safety call
- All-staff briefing 60–90 minutes before gates open: radio/wristband/shirt distribution, zone map handout, weather-call authority reminder
- Printed run-of-show and zone map issued to every Zone Captain, not just verbally briefed

6. High-Level Timeline

Milestone	Key Actions
T-6 months	Lock event format/date; submit park reservation and special-event permit application; open first stakeholder meeting with Police, Fire/EMS, Public Works, and Engineering; begin vendor/sponsor outreach
T-4 months	Vendor call opens; contract entertainment/animal-race vendor; draft marketing plan; finalize ADA/accessibility site plan
T-3 months	Finalize zone map and signage plan; submit health/fire/temporary-use permits; draft staffing plan; open volunteer recruitment; book rentals (tents, generators, fencing, portable restrooms)
T-8 weeks	Promotional push begins; vendor confirmations due; place signage/print orders
T-5 weeks	Paid/social marketing goes live; press outreach (Queen Creek Independent, Chamber); finalize staff/volunteer roster; lock radio/comms plan
T-2 weeks	Final site walkthrough with PD/Fire/Public Works; finalize run-of-show document; review weather contingency plan; lock minute-by-minute day-of schedule
T-1 week	Final vendor confirmations; volunteer briefing session; confirm equipment delivery; proof all signage
T-3 days	Site delivery: fencing, tents, portable restrooms; test/charge radios
T-1 day	Full site build: field roping, vendor row layout, signage install
Event Day	5:00 AM crew call/site build finalized → 7 AM vendor load-in complete → 8:00 AM staff briefing/radio check → 8:30 AM gate/parking staff posted → 9:00 AM event opens → 9:30 AM first egg hunt wave → 10:00 AM first race heat → 12:15 PM grand prize drawing → 1:00 PM gates close, staggered vendor load-out begins → 2:00–6:00 PM full teardown and site restoration
T+1 week	Staff debrief, vendor satisfaction survey, attendance/engagement metrics documented for next year's planning cycle